This action of the Government of India in superseding the rule of the Maharaja and dispossessing him of his sovereignty, even though his grandfather Maharaja Gulab Singh had signed the Treaty of Amritsar way back in 1846, was unthinkable even in those times. In post-independent India, this action, in later years, became the basis of the right to invoke President's rule in any Indian state. Such a rule suspends the state's existing legislative assembly and removes the elected government whenever there is a perception of a threat to the state or a breakdown of law and order. In post-independent India, the President's rule has been invoked several times in the state of Jammu and Kashmir.



Image 1.5: Map of the Dogra Empire with a picture of its coat of arms (1846–47)
Source: Archives of AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.

The similarities between what the British did and independent India's invoking of the President's rule, are uncanny. In the 19th century, the perceived enemy was Russia and the Maharaja's possible alliance with the Russians was construed by the Government of India to be a threat that was